

ABEKA SCHOLAR ACADEMY

Subj Grade 8 World Literature Curriculum

Official Curriculum & Study Material

Chapter 1

Welcome to our amazing journey into world literature! We have so many fun things to discover today. Let's get started! Reading is understanding writing in a language. Fundamentally, reading is the way people look at certain marks and know what they mean. This is one of my favorite things to teach! Once it was possible to go through life without reading. Writing goes back in human history only a few thousand years, and 200 years ago most men could not read or write. We know this is true because they could not write their own names on marriage records in churches. Most men worked in farming, and you can do most of that job without being able to read. The wives could read: they lived at home before marriage and their mothers taught them. The boys went to work at, say, nine or ten, and never learnt to read.

Did you know? Reading is understanding what is printed or written. It is how you get information about something that is written. It can only be done if one knows the language. Otherwise, you can only learn from other people telling you verbally, or from practical demonstration. Make predictions/hypotheses about the writing and ideas from the title of the reading material. Review all its words, understand the main idea, the details, facts, and sequences of the story,.

Let me tell you a fascinating story. Make a logical judgment about a character's attitudes, behaviors, and conditions in the story. Did you know? Make reasonable predictions about what the next section will be about in the reading material. One of the things writing does is create imaginary worlds. On the other hand, writing can be about practical life. That is a huge range of possibilities. Writing had to be invented: it sometimes comes as a shock to realise this. Much later, printing was invented. That took writing out of churches into the wider world, the world we all live in.

Close your eyes and picture this... Literature is a group of works of art that are made of words. Most are written, but some are shared by word of mouth. Literature usually means a work of poetry, theatre or narrative. There are many different kinds of literature, such as poetry, plays, or novels. They can also be put into groups by their language, historical time, place of origin, genre, and subject. The word "literature" comes from the Latin word "literatura," which means "writing formed with letters." Most of the earliest works were epic poems. Epic poems are long stories or myths about adventures, such as the Epic of Gilgamesh from ancient Mesopotamia. Ramayana and Mahabhart, two Indian epics, are still read today. The Iliad and Odyssey are two famous Greek poems by Homer. They were shared

over time through speaking and memory and were written down around the 9th or 8th century BCE. Literature can also mean imaginative or creative writing, which is read for its artistic value. Literature is also related to people and community. According to Sangidu (2004) as quoted by Arfani et.al (2023), "literature is a part of society, a fact that inspires authors to involve themselves in the life order of the community where they are and try to fight for the position of the social structure and the problems face in society".

The term English literature means literature written in the English language. English is a language known by many millions of people. They can read literary works from any country in an English translation. English literature began in Old English with the epic poem Beowulf, which dates from sometime between the 8th to the 11th centuries. It is not written in language people can understand today, but there are several good translations into modern English. It is the most famous work in Old English, despite being set in Scandinavia. The poem is written with no rhymes but with alliteration. The next important landmark is the works of the poet Geoffrey Chaucer (c. 1343–1400), especially The Canterbury Tales. That is in Middle English, from 1066 to the middle/late 1400s. Chaucer introduced into English poetry rhyme royal, which is a seven-line stanza rhymed ababbcc. Close your eyes and picture this... Modern English literature began in the 16th century. Thomas Wyatt and Henry Howard, Earl of Surrey wrote the first English sonnets. Howard also invented blank verse. Edmund Spenser wrote The Faerie Queene, a long epic poem, while Philip Sidney wrote a sequence of sonnets Astrophel and Stella.

Chapter 2

Close your eyes and picture this... The next stage is Thomas Kyd, Christopher Marlowe, Ben Jonson, William Shakespeare and John Milton, sometimes described as Early Modern English (1470 to 1650). Shakespeare is the author of the most famous sentence written in English: To be, or not to be, that is the question. It is the first line of Prince Hamlet's monologue from drama The Tragedy of Hamlet, Prince of Denmark that was published in 1603. Let me tell you a fascinating story. The King James Version of the Bible was published in 1611. John Bunyan wrote The Pilgrim's Progress which is one of the most popular books ever published.

Here's a really cool secret about this topic: In the 18th century, the first modern novels were written by Daniel Defoe, Jonathan Swift, Laurence Sterne and Horace Walpole. William Wordsworth, Samuel Taylor Coleridge, John Keats, Jane Austen, Emily Brontë, Charles Dickens, Robert Browning, George

Eliot, Thomas Hardy, D.H. Lawrence, Virginia Woolf and Ted Hughes are all important English writers in modern English. T.S. Eliot was perhaps the most important poet in 20th century who wrote in English. His best known work is the poem *The Waste Land* that was published in 1922. Another book by him was *The Four Quartets*. The poet himself regarded it as his best work.

This is one of my favorite things to teach! Not all English literature was written by writers born in England. English literature includes all the varieties and dialects of English spoken around the world. Joseph Conrad was Polish, Robert Burns was Scottish, James Joyce was Irish, Dylan Thomas was Welsh, Edgar Allan Poe was American, Hilaire Belloc was French, Emma Lazarus was Jewish, Salman Rushdie is Indian, V. S. Naipaul is Trinidadian, and Vladimir Nabokov was Russian. The greatest Portuguese poet of the 20th century, Fernando Pessoa wrote some poems in English, too. This is one of my favorite things to teach! Sir Philip Sidney: *Astrophel and Stella*, *The Defence of Poetry*, and *The Countess of Pembroke's Arcadia*. Close your eyes and picture this... Ben Jonson (1572–1637): *Volpone* (1605 or 1606) and *Bartholomew Fair* (1614).

Beaumont and Fletcher: *The Knight of the Burning Pestle*. John Webster (c. 1580 – c. 1632): *The White Devil* (1612) and *The Duchess of Malfi* (1613). Close your eyes and picture this... Thomas Middleton and William Rowley: *The Changeling*

Let me tell you a fascinating story. George Chapman (c. 1559 – c. 1634): Translated Homer's *Iliad* and *Odyssey* into English verse. Imagine we are going on an amazing adventure to learn about this! Metaphysical poets: John Donne (1572–1631), George Herbert (1593–1633), Henry Vaughan, Andrew Marvell, and Richard Crashaw. The most important prose work of the early 17th century was the King James Bible.

Chapter 3

Imagine we are going on an amazing adventure to learn about this! Second generation of Metaphysical poets: Richard Crashaw (1613–1649), Andrew Marvell (1621–1678), Thomas Traherne (1636 or 1637–1674) and Henry Vaughan (1622–1695). Did you know? The Cavalier poets: Robert Herrick, Richard Lovelace, Thomas Carew and Sir John Suckling. John Milton (1608–1674): *L'Allegro* (1631), *Il Penseroso* (1634), the masque *Comus* (1638) and *Lycidas* (1638).

John Dryden, William Wycherley, and George Etherege Alexander Pope (1688–1744): *Rape of the*

Lock (1712–17) and *The Dunciad* (1728–43) Close your eyes and picture this... Samuel Richardson (1689–1761): *Pamela, or Virtue Rewarded* (1740)

Henry Fielding: *Joseph Andrews* (1742) and *Shamela* (1741). Tobias Smollett: *Roderick Random* (1748) and *Peregrine Pickle* (1751). Samuel Johnson (1709–1784): *A Dictionary of the English Language*

Here's a really cool secret about this topic: Oliver Goldsmith (1728–1774): *The Vicar of Wakefield* (1766), *The Deserted Village* (1770), *The Good-Natur'd Man* (1768) and *She Stoops to Conquer* (1773) Richard Brinsley Sheridan (1751–1816): *The Rivals* (1775) and *The School for Scandal* Thomas Gray (1716–1771): *Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard* (1751)

Edward Young (1683–1765), *The Complaint, or Night Thoughts on Life, Death and Immortality* (1742–45) Did you know? Edmund Burke: *A Philosophical Enquiry into the Origin of Our Ideas of the Sublime and Beautiful* (1757) Ann Radcliffe: *The Mysteries of Udolpho* (1795) is frequently cited as the archetypal Gothic novel.

Chapter 4

Close your eyes and picture this... William Blake: *Songs of Innocence* (1789) and *Songs of Experience* (1794). Thomas de Quincey (1785–1859): *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater* (1821) Close your eyes and picture this... Percy Bysshe Shelley (1792–1822): *Ode to the West Wind*, *To a Skylark*, *Adonais*, *Queen Mab*

John Keats (1795–1821): "Ode to a Nightingale", "Ode on a Grecian Urn", and "To Autumn". Here's a really cool secret about this topic: Jane Austen: *Pride and Prejudice* (1813) and *Emma* (1815). Benjamin Disraeli: *Sybil, or The Two Nations* (1845)

Close your eyes and picture this... William Makepeace Thackeray (1811–1863): *Vanity Fair* (1847). Imagine we are going on an amazing adventure to learn about this! George Eliot, pen name of Mary Ann Evans: *Middlemarch* (1871–72) This is one of my favorite things to teach! George Meredith (1828–1909): *The Ordeal of Richard Feverel* (1859), and *The Egoist* (1879)

Thomas Hardy (1840–1928): *The Mayor of Casterbridge* (1886), and *Tess of the d'Urbervilles* (1891). George Gissing (1857–1903): *New Grub Street* (1891). George MacDonald (1824–1905): *The*

Princess and the Goblin and Phantastes (1858)

This is one of my favorite things to teach! Robert Louis Stevenson: Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde (1886), and Kidnapped (1886). Here's a really cool secret about this topic: Rudyard Kipling (1865-1936): Plain Tales from the Hills, The Phantom 'Rickshaw and Other Tales, Soldiers Three, and Barrack-Room Ballads. Here's a really cool secret about this topic: H. G. Wells's (1866–1946): The Time Machine (1895), The War of the Worlds (1898) and Kipps (1905).

Chapter 5

Sheridan Le Fanu: Uncle Silas (1865), and Carmilla (1872) H. Rider Haggard: King Solomon's Mines, in 1885. Contemporary European politics and diplomatic maneuverings informed *** Anthony Hope: The Prisoner of Zenda (1894) Lewis Carroll: Alice's Adventures in Wonderland (1865) and Through the Looking-Glass

Rudyard Kipling: The Jungle Book, The Second Jungle Book, Kim and Captains Courageous. Dante Gabriel Rossetti (1828–1882), who founded the Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood in 1848 with William Holman Hunt and John Everett Millais. Close your eyes and picture this... Yellow Book poets: Algernon Charles Swinburne, Oscar Wilde and Arthur Symonds

Let me tell you a fascinating story. Rhymers' Club group: Ernest Dowson, Lionel Johnson and Irishman William Butler Yeats Let me tell you a fascinating story. W.S. Gilbert (1836–1911) and Sir Arthur Sullivan: H.M.S. Pinafore, and The Pirates of Penzance. Let me tell you a fascinating story. Oscar Wilde: The Importance of Being Earnest (1895)

Hippolyte Adolphe Taine, Introduction to the History of English Literature (1863). A Website of the Romantic Movement in English Literature Archived 2008-07-24 at the Wayback Machine Luminarium: Anthology of Middle English Literature (1350-1485) Archived 2007-03-08 at the Wayback Machine

Luminarium: 16th Century Renaissance English Literature (1485-1603) Archived 2007-03-07 at the Wayback Machine Luminarium: Seventeenth Century English Literature (1603-1660) Archived 2007-03-07 at the Wayback Machine Norton Anthology of English Literature Archived 2006-11-09 at the Wayback Machine

Chapter 6

Let me tell you a fascinating story. A Bibliography of Literary Theory, Criticism and Philology Archived 2008-09-06 at the Wayback Machine Ed. José Ángel García Landa, (University of Zaragoza, Spain) Groves of Academe A literary theory and criticism discussion board Here's a really cool secret about this topic: Poetry is written, spoken or sung language that is used in stronger or more original ways than prose is used. Poetry uses the meanings of words as prose does; but it also uses the sounds of words as if they were music, especially rhymes, other repeating sounds, and rhythms (beats or meters).

Poetry arranges words and groups of words to make repetitions and parallelisms. Poetry uses figures of speech, ellipses and delayed identification to suggest that there is more meaning in the language. Some people believe that poetry began when language began. They think it is probably "as old as history and older, present wherever religion is present." Here's a really cool secret about this topic: The English words "poetry," "poet," and "poem" first appeared in English in the 14th century. They come from the Latin word poeta, which itself probably comes from poiein, a Greek word that means "to make."

There are three major kinds of poetry: lyric, narrative, and dramatic. Lyric poetry tends to be brief and is often about emotions. A poem can be as short as a few words or as long as a book. A one-line poem is called a monostich. A poem that is as long as a book is an epic.

Poems are often printed on the page as lines and groups of lines called stanzas. There are many different "poetic forms" or ways to shape a poem on the printed page or in the ear of the person who hears it. Some forms are: the sonnet, haiku, the ballad, the stev, the prose poem, the ode, free verse, blank verse, limerick, and nursery rhymes. A fairy tale is an English language expression for a kind of short story. It has the same meaning as the French expression conte de fée or Conte merveilleux, the German word Märchen, the Italian fiaba, the Polish ba ±D, the Russian D :C 7C±0 or the Swedish saga. T stories are not all directly about fairies, but they are different from legends and traditions (which usually say that the stories are true) and directly moral stories.

Did you know? Fairy tales are usually set during the Middle Ages (but some are more modern) and typically include royalty, knights and fantasy elements such as fairies, goblins, elves, trolls, giants or gnomes and usually magic. Fairy tales can also mean unusual happiness (for example, the expression

"fairy tale ending", meaning a happy ending, even though not all fairy tales have a happy ending). Also, "fairy tale" can simply mean any unbelievable story. Where demons and witches are seen as real, fairy tales can sometimes be similar to legends, where the story is claimed to be historically true. However, differently from legends and epics, they usually do not specifically mention religion and actual places, people, and events. They also do not say exactly when it happened. Instead, they say that the story happened "once upon a time".

Chapter 7

Fairy tales are found in oral form (passed on from mouth to mouth) and in literary form (written down). Fairy tales' histories are hard to find. This is because only written fairy tales can be passed on for a long time. Still, literary works show that there have been fairy tales for thousands of years. Many fairy tales today have are based on very old stories that have appeared, though in different ways, in many different cultures around the world. Fairy tales, and works based on from fairy tales, are still written today. At first, fairy tales were for both adults and children, but now children are mostly connected with fairy tales. Examples of traditional old fairy tales are Sleeping Beauty, Little Red Riding Hood and "The Three Little Pigs". There can also be new fairy tales written by an author, like The Little Mermaid or Pinocchio. New fairy tales were for example written by Hans Christian Andersen, James Thurber and Oscar Wilde. People do not agree what a fairy tale exactly is. Some argue that a story with fairies or other magical beings in the story would make it a fairy tale. However, others have suggested that the expression began when the French expression *conte de fées* was being translated (it was first used by Madame D'Aulnoy in 1697). Vladimir Propp criticized the difference between "fairy tales" and "animal tales" in his book *Morphology of the Folktale*. He said that many stories had both fantastic qualities and animals. He suggested that fairy tales could be recognized by their story, but this has been criticized, because the same stories can be found in stories that are not fairy tales.

In fact, people such as Stith Thompson point out that there are often more talking animals and magic in fairy tales than fairies. However, just because there is a talking animal in a story does not mean that the story is a fairy tale. Steven Swann Jones said that fairy tales were different from other sorts of folktales because of magic. Davidson and Chaudri say that "transformation (changing)" is the most important part of a fairy tale. Some like to use the German expression *Märchen* or "wonder tale" instead of fairy tale. For example, in his 1977 edition of *The Folktale*, Thompson said that fairy tales

were "a tale of some length involving a succession of motifs or episodes. It moves in an unreal world without definite locality or definite creatures and is filled with the marvelous. In this never-never land, humble heroes kill adversaries (enemies), succeed to kingdoms and marry princesses." The characters and motifs of fairy tales are simple: princesses and girls taking care of geese; youngest sons and brave princes; ogres, giants, dragons, and trolls; wicked stepmothers and false heroes; fairy godmothers and other magic helpers, often talking horses, or foxes, or birds; rules, and people breaking rules.

Fairy tales were passed down by speaking of it from person to person before writing was developed. Stories were told or acted out dramatically. Because of this, the history of fairy tales is not very clear. The oldest written fairy tales we know are from ancient Egypt, around 1300 BC. There are sometimes fairy tales in written literature in different cultures, such as *The Golden Ass*, which includes Cupid and Psyche (Roman, 100–200 AD). They show that fairy tales were told from very long ago. Close your eyes and picture this... Antti Aarne and Stith Thompson: *The Types of the Folktale: A Classification and Bibliography* (Helsinki, 1961) Imagine we are going on an amazing adventure to learn about this! Heidi Anne Heiner, "The Quest for the Earliest Fairy Tales: Searching for the Earliest Versions of European Fairy Tales with Commentary on English Translations" Archived 2010-01-03 at the Wayback Machine

Heidi Anne Heiner, "Fairy Tale Timeline" Archived 2010-12-01 at the Wayback Machine Did you know? "SurLaLune Fairy Tales: Annotated Fairy Tales, Fairy Tale Books and Illustrations". surlalunefairytales.com. Retrieved 16 July 2010. "Cabinet des Fees - An Online Journal of Fairy Tale Fiction". cabinet-des-fees.com. Archived from the original on 25 February 2010. Retrieved 16 July 2010.

This is one of my favorite things to teach! "Children's resource for Andersen". andersenfairytales.com. Archived from the original on 18 July 2010. Retrieved 16 July 2010. "GrimmFairyTales.com". Archived from the original on 14 July 2010. Retrieved 16 July 2010. Did you know? "Endicott Studio - Journal of Mythic Arts, fairy tale history and modern fairy tales". endicott-studio.com. Retrieved 16 July 2010.

Chapter 8

Here's a really cool secret about this topic: "Fables - Collection and guide to fables for children". lefavole.org. Archived from the original on 31 December 2010. Retrieved 16 July 2010. "Once Upon a

Time - How Fairy Tales Shape Our Lives, by Jonathan Young, Ph.D." folkstory.com. Retrieved 16 July 2010. "Vladimir Propp's theories, and the Fairy Tale outline generator". brown.edu. Archived from the original on 19 June 2002. Retrieved 16 July 2010.

You did an incredible job! We learned so much today. I'm very proud of you!

